

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: From Farid to Sher Shah

FARID -> practical exposure in family parganas around Sasaram

BIHAR POLITICS -> service, alliances, revenue knowledge and fort strategy

SHER KHAN -> enlarges an Afghan regional base after Panipat

SURAJGARH / GAUR -> Bengal resources and corridor depth

CHAUSA 1539 + KANNAUJ 1540 -> Mughal displacement and Sur sovereignty

VERDICT: administrative experience and opportunity precede imperial scale.

MUST REMEMBER: Sher Shah's reign (1540-45) linked conquest to sarkar-pargana administration, revenue, roads, sarais and currency.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Sur chronology c.1510-1555

c.1510 -> Farid gains pargana-level experience

1534 -> Surajgarh | 1537 -> Gaur captured by Sher Khan's side

1539 -> Chausa | 1540 -> Kannauj and formal sovereignty

1542 -> Malwa | 1543-44 -> Multan, upper Sindh and Rajasthan fields

1544 -> Samel | May 1545 -> death during Kalinjar siege

1545-53 -> Islam Shah | 1555 -> Humayun returns after fragmentation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Bihar-Bengal scale-up to sovereignty

LOCAL BASE -> land knowledge + Afghan followers + forts + revenue

BENGAL CONTEST -> Surajgarh and Gaur enlarge resources and reputation

ROUTE CONTROL -> Gangetic communications expose Humayun's eastern campaign

MILITARY VICTORY -> Chausa and Kannauj redistribute forts and elite loyalty

POLITICAL TASK -> battlefield success must become collection and enforcement

OUTCOME: Sher Khan becomes Sher Shah by converting scale into sovereignty.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Empire and campaign fields

BENGAL TO INDUS -> useful claim for the broad reach of the Sur realm
KASHMIR -> explicitly excluded from the standard extent formula
MALWA 1542 -> western-central expansion
MULTAN / UPPER SINDH -> north-western campaign and corridor field
RAJASTHAN / SAMEL -> coercion, negotiation and uneven control
RULE: map corridors, forts and campaigns; do not draw a modern solid border.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Afghan monarchy and personal supervision

AFGHAN NOBLES -> expectations of dignity, counsel and assignments

SHER SHAH -> forceful monarchy, direct scrutiny and rapid decision

STRENGTH -> coordination can be concentrated under a masterful sovereign

LIMIT -> jagir/iqta expectations and coalition politics do not disappear

SUCCESSION -> Islam Shah asserts monarchy but deepens noble resentment

FRAGILITY -> high personal capacity is difficult to reproduce after the ruler.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Territory and mediated countryside

SOVEREIGN CENTRE

- > SARKAR / SHIQ: territorial command and overlapping officials
- > PARGANA: assessment, records, policing and local information
- > VILLAGE: cultivators, muqaddams and other intermediaries

ZAMINDARS -> controlled, punished or negotiated with; not abolished

TRAP: this was neither Akbar's mature suba system nor modern ryotwari.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Revenue measurement and record chain

SOWN LAND -> measurement

- > good / middling / bad classification
- > average yield and crop-rate schedule (rai)
- > general one-third state demand
- > patta records area, crop and amount due

QUALIFY -> cash/kind, local mediation, annual practice and Multan exception.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Road-sarai-customs-dak circulation system

ROADS -> old imperial corridors restored and improved

FOUR-ROAD FRAME -> Indus-Sonargaon; Agra-Rajasthan; Lahore-Multan; Burhanpur

SARAIS -> lodging + markets + relay + surveillance at two-karoh intervals

DAK / NEWS -> information and orders move through nodal stations

CUSTOMS -> duties simplified around entry and sale

RESULT -> commerce, army movement and coercive reach reinforce one another.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Money, order and military controls

RUPEE -> fine silver standard with durable later influence, not first coin
TRIMETALLIC FIELD -> gold, silver and copper support exchange and payments
LAW AND ORDER -> merchant safety backed by harsh collective responsibility
CHEHRA -> descriptive roll of soldiers | DAGH -> branding of horses
CONTINUITY -> Alauddin precedent; Sher Shah revival; Akbar systematisation
RULE: administrative effectiveness is not the same as modern legality.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Forts, religion and succession limits

ROHTAS, NORTHWEST -> frontier control and Mughal-return check

ROHTASGARH, BIHAR -> distinct site; never conflate the two forts

RAISEN / PURAN MAL -> violence with political and religious readings

KALINJAR 1545 -> siege death ends Sher Shah's personal direction

ISLAM SHAH -> continuity plus sharper conflict with Afghan nobles

SUR COLLAPSE -> succession and faction reopen the field to Humayun.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Patta-qabuliyat and measurement claims need source-aware wording rather than projection of later uniform practice.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Continuity, source method and Akbar

SULTANATE -> measurement, assignments, dagh-chehra and road precedents

SUR -> practical revival, standardisation and fast integrated implementation

AKBAR -> wider scale, longer duration, mansabdari and refined revenue systems

SARWANI -> valuable retrospective Afghan memory; praise needs corroboration

SASARAM TOMB -> material evidence for patronage and legitimacy, not every reform

VERDICT: Sher Shah was a bridge and systematiser, not Akbar's full blueprint.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Calling Sher Shah a Mughal precursor is useful only when institutional continuity and later adaptation are qualified.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 14 answer spine

OPEN -> short reign, dense state-building and a longer Sur phase

RISE -> pargana experience + Bihar-Bengal base + Mughal displacement

CAPACITY -> revenue + money + roads + information + order + military controls

MEDIATION -> zamindars and local officials remain inside the system

LIMITS -> uneven reach, harsh coercion, personal supervision and succession

CLOSE -> achievement lay in integration and execution within a longer process.